- Psychiatric Aids-ECT Technician
- Occupational Therapist
- Recreational Therapist
- Diversional / Play Therapist / Art Therapist
- Clergyman (religious leader)

Principles of Psychiatric Nursing

- Accept the patients as exactly as they are
- Use self-understanding as a therapeutic tool
- Use self-awareness when dealing with clients
- Focuses on the strengths, not on weaknesses of client
- Views the client's behavior non-judgmentally
- Establish and maintain therapeutic nurse –client relationship
- Ensure clients security
- Give reassurance to the client in an acceptable manner
- Change the client's behavior by emotional experience
- Avoid approaches which will increase the client's anxiety
- Avoid physical and verbal forces as much as possible
- Maintain the basic principles of nursing while following any procedure
- Nursing care centered on client as a person
- Explain routines and procedures at the client level of understanding

10.3 Misconception about Mental Illness

- Mental illness is caused by supernatural power
- It is the result of curse by evil spirit.
- Mentally ill people are violent.
- Mental illness is something to be ashamed of.
- Mental illness can not be cured.
- Marriage can cure mental illness.
- Only adults and older adults experience mental illnesses.



- The father of psychiatry is Asciepiades.
- The first mental asylum in India is Dhar near Madhya Pradesh



Activity 1

Teacher Activity

Arrange a visit to nearby mental health hospital and orient the functions of that unit

Student Activity

Submit a report on orientation programme to mental health hospital and its functions.Recall the various emotions experienced in the past one week, state the reason and classify and submit the report.

10.4 Understanding of Patients

Understanding of psychiatric patients is very important in mental health nursing. So a psychiatric and nursing assessment is necessary. A psychiatric assessment is a process of gathering information about a client from a person within a mental health service, with the purpose of making a diagnosis. The assessment is usually the first stage of a treatment process, but psychiatric assessments may also be used for various legal purposes.

Nursing process is defined as a systematic, continuous and dynamic method of providing care to clients.

Steps in Nursing Process

- **ASSESSMENT:** collection of all the data that are adequate and relevant.
- **DIAGNOSIS:** Analyzing the data and find out the diagnosis.

Unit_10_Mental_health_Gen_Nur.indd 220 09-03-2020 15:07:09